



Q

Why do we blanch vegetables before freezing or drying them when preserving food at home?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To stop enzyme action that can change color and flavor

FUN FACT

Blanching helps veggies stay tasty and fresh-looking in your freezer!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

What kind of foods need to be pressure canned instead of using a boiling water canner?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Low acid foods like vegetables, meat, fish, and poultry

FUN FACT

Using the right canning method keeps your meals safe and yummy!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

When a grown-up is canning food at home, why is it important that they heat the jars long enough?

FOOD SAFETY



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because heating the jars enough helps stop tiny germs from growing that could make people very sick.

FUN FACT

Some germs can be dangerous if not stopped by heating, but proper canning keeps food safe to eat!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

When a grown-up is canning fruits or pickles, why do they pay attention to how sour (or tart) the food is?



ANSWER

Because sour foods help keep bad germs from growing inside the jar.

FUN FACT

Most fruits and pickles are naturally sour, which helps keep them safe to preserve in jars!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

When you watch a grown-up feeding a baby under 1 year old, why do they avoid giving the baby honey?

FOOD SAFETY



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because honey can have tiny germs that babies' tummies aren't ready to handle yet.

FUN FACT

Babies' tummies are still learning, so grown-ups wait until they're older before giving them honey to keep them safe!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

What should you do if you see mold growing on home-canned food?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Throw it away right away to stay safe

FUN FACT

Some molds look fuzzy but can make you very sick!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

Why is it important to wash fresh fruits and vegetables just before you eat them?

FOOD SAFETY



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To remove dirt and germs that can cause illness

FUN FACT

Washing helps keep those sneaky germs away!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

What is the safest temperature range to keep foods cold in your fridge to stop bacteria growth?

FOOD SAFETY



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Below 40°F (4°C)

FUN FACT

Cold fridges slow down bacteria so your food stays safe longer!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

Why is it important to keep cooked eggs hot (above 140°F) or cold (below 40°F)?



ANSWER

To stop bacteria from growing on them

FUN FACT

Bacteria can grow fast in cooked eggs if they're left at room temperature too long!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

When you watch a grown-up preserve foods that don't have much acid, why do they need to follow the recipe carefully with the right steps and timing?

FOOD SAFETY



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because if they don't, some germs might survive and could make people sick.

FUN FACT

Carefully following tested recipes helps keep preserved food safe to eat!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

What is the best way to cool down large pots of hot food quickly before putting them in the fridge?

FOOD SAFETY



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

**Put the pot in cold or ice water
and stir it often**

FUN FACT

*Cooling food fast stops harmful
bacteria from growing!*

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne
illness



Q

When home canning pickles, which acid is important to add to keep them safe?



ANSWER

Vinegar, to keep acidity high

FUN FACT

Vinegar's acid helps keep pickles safe from bad bacteria!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

What might happen if a grown-up tries to preserve raw milk or dairy products in a special canning pot at home?



ANSWER

The milk might not stay safe because it can let harmful germs grow.

FUN FACT

Milk needs special ways to be safe, so most people use milk that has been pasteurized, which means it's been gently heated to kill germs before you buy it.

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

Why must your kitchen be clean when preserving food at home?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To keep bacteria and molds from contaminating your food

FUN FACT

A clean kitchen helps your food stay safe and tasty!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

If canned food shows bubbles or smells bad, what should you do?



ANSWER

Throw it away because it might have harmful bacteria

FUN FACT

Bubbles or off smells can mean dangerous germs inside canned food!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

Why should eggs be cooked until both the white and yolk are firm?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To kill any *Salmonella* bacteria that might be inside

FUN FACT

Cooking eggs well helps keep you healthy!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

When a grown-up puts garlic or herbs in oil and leaves it out on the counter, what might happen to the food?



ANSWER

Harmful germs can grow and make the food unsafe to eat.

FUN FACT

Garlic or herbs in oil should always be kept in the fridge and used quickly to keep them safe and fresh!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness



Q

Why is it important to use tested and up-to-date recipes for home canning?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They ensure food is processed safely to avoid foodborne illness

FUN FACT

Good recipes keep your home-canned food safe and yummy!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

When a grown-up seals food inside a can or jar, why do they make sure there's no air inside?

FOOD SAFETY



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because without air, some bad germs can grow and make the food unsafe to eat.

FUN FACT

Some harmful germs like to grow in places with no air and can make foods unsafe if not canned properly!

Source: SP 50-1000 Turkey basics



Q

Why should you not store eggs in the refrigerator door?



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because temperature in the door changes a lot and can let bacteria grow

FUN FACT

Keep eggs cold and steady in the fridge, not in the door!

Source: PNW 250 You can prevent food borne illness